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General Knowledge
Ancient History

STUDY NOTES

Books and Authors

Books and Authors (Medieval History)

In medieval history, literature emerged in various forms, reflecting the political, religious, and social changes of the period. The literature of this era is not limited to a single language or genre but spans a wide array of regional languages, literary traditions, and genres. The diversity of medieval literature can be seen across Persian, Arabic, Urdu, and regional languages like Sanskrit, Hindi, Tamil, and Bengali. Each of these languages played a crucial role in shaping the intellectual and cultural fabric of medieval societies.

Category	**Language(s)**	**Context**	**Key Themes**	**Notable Works**	**Key Figures**
Persian Literature	Persian	Flourished under Delhi Sultanate and Mughal Empire; Court language	Courtly life, mysticism, love, nature	Shahnameh (Ferdowsi), Rubaiyat (Omar Khayyam), Masnavi (Rumi), Gulistan (Saadi)	Amir Khusro, Siraj-ud-Din Ali Khan Arzu
Arabic Literature	Arabic	Spread through Islamic empires; a language of scholarship and religion	Religious texts, philosophy, law, poetry	The Quran (religious), Kitab al-Shifa (Qadi Iyad), works of Al-Biruni and Ibn Sina	Al-Biruni, Ibn Sina, Al-Farabi
Urdu Literature	Urdu (derived from Persian, Arabic, Hindi)	Emerged in Mughal period, blending Persian, Arabic, and local languages	Romance, mysticism, Sufism, love	Diwan-e-Ghalib (Mirza Ghalib), Shahjahan Nama (Insha Allah Khan), Farsi Ghazals	Mirza Ghalib, Allama Iqbal, Siraj-ud-Din Ali Khan Arzu
Other Medieval Literature	Various regional languages	Influenced by religious, cultural, and	Religious devotion, folklore,	Ramcharitmanas (Tulsidas), Bhakti literature in	Kabir, Tulsidas, Sant

	(Hindi, Marathi, Tamil, Bengali, etc.)	political changes in regions	historical narratives	regional languages, Folk tales and epics in various regions	Tukaram
Classical Literature	Greek, Roman, Sanskrit, Arabic	Preservation and transmission of ancient knowledge across cultures	Philosophy, mythology, ethics	Translations of Greek and Roman texts into Arabic, Vedas, Upanishads, Bhagavad Gita	Al-Farabi, Ibn Sina
Religious Literature	Various (Arabic, Persian, Hindi)	Flourished during periods of religious movements like Bhakti and Sufism	Devotion, spirituality, divine love	The Quran (Islamic), Ramcharitmanas (Hindu), works by Kabir, Guru Nanak	Kabir, Guru Nanak, Tulsidas
Other Forms of Literature	Various languages (including Arabic, Persian, and regional)	Folk literature, historical works, and scientific texts	Astronomy, medicine, history, folklore	Ain-i-Akbari (Abu'l-Fazl), Kulliyat-e-Danesh (medical treatise), Folk tales	Abu'l-Fazl, Various scholars

Books and authors from the 8th century onwards

Time Period	Book/Work	Author/Translator	Details
8th Century	Kitab al-Fihrist	Ibn al-Nadim	A catalog of books and authors, an important source for understanding early Islamic

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			literature.
	Kitab al-Hind	Al-Biruni	A comprehensive account of Indian culture, science, and religion written after he visits India.
	Tahkik-i-hind		A comprehensive account of Indian culture, religion, and philosophy, written in Arabic. Alberuni's work provides valuable insights into the intellectual and spiritual life of India in the 11th century and is considered a classic of Islamic scholarship.
	Kitab al-Asar	Abu Hanifa Dinawari	A work on natural science and botany in Arabic.
9th Century	Chachnama	Translated into Persian by Ali Kufi (13th century)	Chronicles the Arab conquest of Sindh, based on

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			older Arabic accounts.
	Muruj al-Dhahab	Al-Masudi	Describes the geography, history, and cultures of various regions, including India.
	Silsilat al-Tawarikh	Sulaiman	A travelogue mentioning Indian rulers like Mihir Bhoja.
	Kalila wa Dimna	Ibn al-Muqaffa (translator)	An Arabic translation of Panchatantra from Middle Persian (Pahlavi).
10th Century	Kitab al-Musiqa al-Kabir	Al-Farabi	A treatise on music theory, reflecting the blend of Persian, Arabic, and Greek traditions.
11th Century	Shahnameh	Ferdowsi	A Persian epic chronicling the history of Iran from mythological times to the Islamic conquest.

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12th Century	Rubaiyat	Omar Khayyam	A collection of quatrains (rubaiyat) exploring themes of life, mortality, and philosophy.
14th Century	Rihla	Ibn Battuta	A travelogue documenting the author's journeys, including his time in India under Muhammad bin Tughlaq.

Delhi Sultanate period

Book	Author	Details
Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Minhaj-us-Siraj	A comprehensive history of Muslim rulers in India, dedicated to Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud.
Tarikh-i-Firuz Shahi	Ziauddin Barani	It covers the history of the Delhi Sultanate, focusing on the reigns of Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq and Firuz Shah Tughlaq.
Fatawa-i-Jahandari	Ziauddin Barani	A political treatise outlining the principles of governance under Islamic rule.
Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi	Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi	Chronicles the history of the Sayyid and early Lodi dynasties.
Futuhat-i-Firuz Shahi	Sultan Firuz Shah Tughlaq	An autobiographical account of Firuz Shah Tughlaq's

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		achievements and reforms.
Amir Khusrau's Works	Amir Khusrau	It includes Tughlaqnama, Khazain-ul-Futuh, and Qiran-us-Sa'dain, which depict historical and cultural aspects.
Khazain-ul-Futuh	Amir Khusrau	Chronicles Alauddin Khalji's conquests and administration.
Qiran-us-Sa'dain	Amir Khusrau	Documents the meeting of Sultan Kaiqubad and his father Bughra Khan.
Ashiqa	Amir Khusrau	A romantic masnavi, blending Persian literary tradition with Indian themes.
Diwan-i-Hafiz	Hafiz Shirazi	Persian poetry was popular in the Sultanate courts (translated during this period).
Adab-ul-Harb wa Shujaat	Fakhr-i-Mudabbir	A manual on the art of war and statecraft.
Shahnama-i-Islam	Abdul Malik Isami	An epic poem describing the rise of Islam and events during the Delhi Sultanate.
Taj-ul-Maasir	Hasan Nizami	History of the early Ghurid and Delhi Sultanate rulers, particularly Qutbuddin Aibak.
Tarikh-i-Yamini	Al-Utbi	It focuses on the reign of Mahmud of Ghazni, whose invasions preceded the Sultanate era.
Mirat-i-Sikandari	Sikandar bin Muhammad	Chronicles the Gujarat Sultanate, often overlapping with Delhi Sultanate history.

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Mughal Era (16th to 18th century)

Book	Author	Details
Akbarnama	Abul Fazl	Official history of Akbar's reign; includes details of administration and policies.
Ain-i-Akbari	Abul Fazl	A part of Akbarnama, detailing Akbar's administration, society, and economy.
Baburnama	Babur	Autobiography of Babur, the founder of the Mughal Empire, written in Chagatai Turkish.
Humayun-Nama	Gulbadan Begum	Biography of Humayun, written by his half-sister Gulbadan Begum.
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	Jahangir	Autobiography of Jahangir, discussing his rule, administration, and personal life.
Shah Jahan Nama	Inayat Khan	Chronicles the reign of Shah Jahan.
Padshahnama	Abdul Hamid Lahori	History of Shah Jahan's reign, commissioned by the emperor.
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	Badauni	A critical history of the Mughal period, often disapproving of Akbar's policies.
Tarikh-i-Alfi	Multiple authors	A comprehensive history of a thousand years of Islam, initiated by Akbar.
Akhlaq-i-Humayuni	Khwandamir	A treatise on ethics and administration during

		Humayun's reign.
Tabaqat-i-Akbari	Nizamuddin Ahmad	A detailed account of the Mughal Empire until Akbar's reign.
Maathir-i-Alamgiri	Muhammad Saqi Mustaid Khan	Chronicles the reign of Aurangzeb.
Chahar Gulshan	Rai Chaturman	Describes the Mughal territories and their administration under Aurangzeb.
Risalah-i-Sahibiya	Shah Waliullah	A theological work reflecting on Islamic jurisprudence during the Mughal period.
Futuhat-i-Alamgiri	Ishwardas Nagar	History of Aurangzeb's military campaigns.
Sirr-i-Akbar	Dara Shikoh	Persian translation of 50 Upanishads, showcasing syncretic religious ideas.
Majma-ul-Bahrain	Dara Shikoh	A philosophical treatise comparing Hinduism and Islam.
Bustan and Gulistan	Saadi (popular works)	Persian poetry was widely studied in the Mughal courts.
Diwan-i-Ghalib	Mirza Ghalib	Poetry reflects Mughal India's culture and decline (later Mughal period).

Notable books and authors associated with the Maratha state

Book/Work	Author	Details
Bakhar Literature	Multiple authors (anonymous/official chroniclers)	Historical narratives of the Maratha Empire, including works like Sabhasad Bakhar, Chitnis Bakhar, and Panipat Bakhar.
Sabhasad Bakhar	Krishnaji Anant Sabhasad	Chronicles the life and conquests of Shivaji, written during the late 17th century.
Chitnis Bakhar	Malhar Ramrao Chitnis	Focuses on the Maratha state under Shivaji and later rulers.
Adnyapatra (Royal Edict)	Ramchandra Pant Amatya	A manual on statecraft, administration, and military tactics was written for Maratha rulers.
Rajyavyavahara Kosha	Moropant Trimbak Pingle	Administrative glossary used during the Maratha reign.
Shivabharat	Paramananda	A Sanskrit poetic biography of Shivaji, glorifying his achievements.
Shivaji's Correspondence	Compiled by various scholars	Letters were exchanged between Shivaji, his ministers, and other leaders, offering insights into governance and diplomacy.
Bhushan's Poetry	Bhushan (poet in Shivaji's court)	Eulogizes Shivaji in works like Shivraj Bhushan and Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj's achievements.

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Raghunath Pandit's Works	Raghunath Pandit	Court poet under Shivaji, known for his Marathi and Sanskrit compositions.
Tuzuk-i-Marathas	Persian chroniclers	Accounts by Persian historians, recording Maratha's interactions with the Mughal Empire.
Prahlad Niranjan's Bhajans	Prahlad Niranjan	Bhajans and spiritual poetry reflect Maratha's cultural and religious values.

Other Medieval Literature

Region/Language	Author	Notable Works	Influence
Hindi	Tulsidas	Ramcharitmanas	Bhakti literature, devotion to Lord Rama
Hindi	Kabir	Bijak	Spiritual poetry, devotion, mysticism
Marathi	Sant Tukaram	Tukaram Gatha	Bhakti literature, devotion to Lord Vithoba
Marathi	Dnyaneshwar	Dnyaneshwari	Philosophical Commentary on Bhagavad Gita
Bengali	Chandidas	Kavya	Bhakti literature, devotion to Radha and Krishna
Bengali	Ramprasad Sen	Ramprasad's Bhakti Poems	Mystical poetry, devotion to Kali

Tamil	Andal	Tiruppavai	Tamil Bhakti literature, devotion to Vishnu
Tamil	Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar	Tevaram	Shaiva Bhakti, hymns in praise of Lord Shiva
Punjabi	Guru Nanak	Japji Sahib	Sikh spiritual philosophy, devotional hymns